

Text Formatting Elements

Generated Jul 8, 2026 8:37 PM

What We'll Learn

By the end of this lesson, students can use basic HTML text formatting elements to emphasize and improve text content on a webpage.

Words We'll Use

- Formatting
- Bold
- Italic
- Emphasis
- Highlight

Before We Start

When you read a webpage, how do bold words, italic words, or highlighted words help you understand important information?

Let's Understand

HTML text formatting elements are used to change the appearance or meaning of text on a webpage.

Some formatting elements make text look different, such as bold, italic, small, marked, or underlined text.

Other formatting elements give meaning to the text, such as showing importance or emphasis.

Text formatting helps readers notice important words, understand key ideas, and read webpage content more clearly.

Let's Look at Examples

Bold and Strong Text



HTML Bold and Strong Text Example

Using `<b>` and `<strong>` to emphasize text

HTML Code

```
1 <!DOCTYPE html>
2 <html>
3   <head>
4     <title>Important Reminder</title>
5   </head>
6   <body>
7     <h1>Class Reminder</h1>
8     <p>Please bring your <b>notebook</b> tomorrow.</p>
9     <p><strong>Important:</strong> Submit your
10      activity before Friday.</p>
11   </body>
12 </html>
13
```

Browser Preview

Class Reminder

Please bring your **notebook** tomorrow.

Important: Submit your activity before Friday.



1. What this shows

`<b>` makes text **bold** for style.
`<strong>` shows important text.



2. Common mistake

```
<p><strong>Important:
Submit your activity.</p>
```

Don't forget the closing `</strong>` tag.



3. Mini-check

Which tag is better for important text:
`<b>` or `<strong>`?

HTML bold and strong text example

Italic and Emphasized Text

This example shows how to use `<i>` and `<em>` to style or emphasize words.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <title>My Favorite Quote</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1>My Favorite Quote</h1>
  <p>My favorite word is <i>creativity</i>.</p>
  <p>I <em>really</em> enjoy learning HTML.</p>
</body>
</html>
```

Common mistake

Students may use italic formatting for too many words, making the paragraph hard to read.

Incorrect:

```
<p><i>I really enjoy learning HTML because it is useful and fun.</i></p>
```

Correct:

```
<p>I <em>really</em> enjoy learning HTML because it is useful and fun.</p>
```

Mini-check

Which tag is used to emphasize a word or phrase?

Highlighted and Small Text

This example shows how to use `<mark>` and `<small>` in a webpage.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <title>School Announcement</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1>School Announcement</h1>
  <p>The deadline for the project is <mark>Friday</mark>.</p>
  <p><small>Please submit your file before the end of class.</small></p>
</body>
</html>
```

Common mistake

Students may use `<mark>` for almost every word, making the highlight less useful.

Incorrect:

```
<p><mark>The deadline for the project is Friday.</mark></p>
```

Correct:

```
<p>The deadline for the project is <mark>Friday</mark>.</p>
```

Mini-check

Which tag is used to highlight important text?

Let's Practice

Create a simple HTML page about your favorite subject.

Your page should include:

- One main heading
- One paragraph
- At least three formatted words or phrases

Use formatting elements such as:

- `<b>`
- `<strong>`
- `<i>`
- `<em>`
- `<mark>`
- `<small>`

Now We Apply

Create a short webpage about a school announcement.

Your webpage should include:

- A heading for the announcement title
- A paragraph explaining the announcement
- Important words formatted properly
- At least one highlighted word or phrase

Challenge Task

Improve your webpage by using at least five different text formatting elements.

Make sure the formatting is meaningful and not used randomly.

How Our Work Will Be Checked

- Correct use of text formatting elements
- Proper opening and closing tags
- Important words are emphasized clearly
- Content is easy to read
- Webpage displays correctly in the browser

Let's Reflect

Which text formatting element is most useful for showing important information? Why?

Resources / References

- [HTML text formatting guide](#)
- [images/html-text-formatting-elements.svg](#)
- [images/html-bold-strong-text.svg](#)
- [images/html-italic-emphasis-text.svg](#)
- [images/html-highlight-small-text.svg](#)